He inherits the terms ***svalakshana*** and ***samanya-lakshana*** from the ***Abhidharma*** tradition. There ***svalakshana*** refers to an individual basic atomic factor (***dharma***) as it is in itself and ***samanya-lakshana*** means the features common to ***dharmas*** when their combinations produce conditioned, macroscopic formations. Such generalities include non-eternity, unsatisfactoriness and lack of permanent identity. He models the notion of the unique instantaneous particular (***svalakshana***) on the ***Abhidharma*** notion of ***dharma***, but he rejects their view that each atomic factor has an unchanging essence.

His contribution to the theory of inference was considerable (see ***Trairupya-hetu***). He insisted that all inferential thought occurred at a remove from reality: 'All this convention involving inferential reason and properties to be established is based on the distinction between property and property-possessor which is itself a feature of the human mind: it is not grounded in anything existing outside the mind.'

See ***Alambana***, ***Apoha-vada***, ***Dharmakirti***

Further reading: Ganeri 2001a; Hattori 1968; Hayes 1988; Matilal 1986; Mookerjee 1975; Oetke 1994

**Dravya** (continuing object or substance): one of the types of objectively real basic features (***padartha***) of the cosmos according to the ***Vaisheshikas***. *Dravyas* are persistently enduring objects with constant natures that possess persisting qualities and transitory motions. Substance is defined as that which lacks the constant absence of qualities and motions. They are not properties of anything else. At the moment of origination, substances lack qualities and motions but the object has an identity in that it belongs to a kind, is the locus of a universal and has a form. A substance or basic particular is a subject distinct from its properties rather than just a confluence of properties. The